
Apex Medical Center: Patient Appointment Guide & Clinic Policies

Welcome to Apex Medical Center. To ensure that our providers can deliver the highest standard of care and maintain an efficient schedule for all patients, we have established the following comprehensive guidelines for booking, canceling, and rescheduling appointments.

1. Provider Directory & Scheduling Availability

Before booking, please review our specialist directory to ensure you are scheduling with the correct department and during their active clinical hours.

| Doctor | Specialty | Clinical Focus | Room | Operating Hours |

| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |

| ****Dr. John Doe**** | Internal Medicine | Preventive Care, Metabolic Disorders | 101 | Mon-Fri: 09:00 - 13:00, 14:00 - 17:00 |

| ****Dr. Sarah Jenkins**** | Pediatrics | Neonatology, Early Childhood Dev. | 104 | Mon, Wed, Fri: 08:30 - 14:30 |

| ****Dr. Rajesh Kumar**** | Cardiology | Interventional Cardiology, Heart Failure | 202 | Tue-Sat: 10:00 - 16:00 |

| ****Dr. Emily Chen**** | Neurology | Movement Disorders, Stroke Rehab | 205 | Mon-Thu: 09:00 - 15:00 |

| ****Dr. Michael Thorne**** | Orthopedics | Sports Medicine, Joint Replacement | 301 | Mon, Wed, Thu: 11:00 - 18:00 |

| ****Dr. Anita Desai**** | Dermatology | Clinical Dermatology, Dermato-Oncology | 304 | Tue-Fri: 09:30 - 13:30 |

| ****Dr. Marcus Vance**** | Psychiatry | Cognitive Behavioral Therapy, Addiction | 402 | Mon, Tue, Thu: 13:00 - 19:00 |

| ****Dr. Elena Rostova**** | Oncology | Medical Hematology, Solid Tumors | 405 | Mon-Fri: 08:00 - 14:00 |

2. Step-by-Step Appointment Booking Procedure

To streamline patient intake and reduce wait times, all patients (or their authorized caregivers) must follow this standard scheduling sequence.

1. ****Identify the Required Specialist:**** Check referrals if necessary.

Review the provider directory above. If your insurance requires a referral to see a specialist (such as Dr. Rostova for Oncology or Dr. Kumar for Cardiology), you must obtain this documentation from your Primary Care Provider before initiating the booking process.

2. ****Gather Necessary Patient Information:****

Prepare the patient's full legal name, date of birth, current contact information, and active insurance card. You will also need a brief, accurate description of the medical reason for the visit so our triage team can allocate the correct appointment length.

3. ****Access the Booking System:****

Patients can book via three channels:

* ****Online Patient Portal:**** Log in to the Apex Medical dashboard 24/7.

* ****Phone:**** Call the centralized scheduling desk during standard business hours.

* ****In-Person:**** Visit the reception desk on the first floor.

4. ****Select an Available Time Slot:****

Cross-reference your availability with the doctor's operating hours. Please note that specialists like Dr. Vance (Psychiatry) and Dr. Thorne (Orthopedics) have afternoon-heavy schedules, whereas Dr. Rostova (Oncology) operates strictly in the mornings.

5. ****Complete Digital Intake Forms:**** Must be completed 24 hours prior to visit.

Once the system generates your confirmation code, a link to your digital intake forms will be sent via email or SMS. These forms cover medical history, current medications, and consent for treatment. Completing these in advance guarantees your appointment time.

3. Cancellation Policies

We understand that emergencies and unforeseen circumstances occur. However, missed appointments prevent other patients from accessing critical medical care. Our cancellation policy is strictly enforced to maximize provider availability.

Standard Notice Requirement

Patients must provide a minimum of ****24 hours' notice**** to cancel an appointment without penalty. This allows our waitlist management team sufficient time to offer the slot to another patient in need.

Late Cancellations

A cancellation is considered "late" if it is made less than 24 hours before the scheduled appointment time.

First Offense: The patient will receive a written warning.

Subsequent Offenses: A late cancellation fee of **\$50.00** will be billed directly to the patient. Insurance does not cover this fee.

No-Show Policy

A "no-show" occurs when a patient fails to attend their scheduled appointment without notifying the clinic at all.

Standard Fee: All no-shows incur an automatic **\$75.00** fee.

Specialist Fee: Due to high demand, no-shows for Dr. Rostova (Oncology) and Dr. Kumar (Cardiology) incur a **\$100.00** fee.

Three-Strike Rule: Any patient who accrues three no-shows within a rolling 12-month period may be subject to dismissal from the practice. They will receive a 30-day notice of care termination, during which only emergency medical services will be provided.

How to Cancel

Cancellations are only accepted via:

1. Directly through the online Patient Portal.
2. Calling the scheduling desk and speaking to a representative.
3. Leaving a time-stamped voicemail on the clinic's dedicated cancellation line (available 24/7). Emails are *not* an accepted method of cancellation due to processing delays.

4. Appointment Rescheduling Policies

Rescheduling differs from canceling, as the intent is to maintain the patient-provider relationship and ensure continuity of care.

Penalty-Free Rescheduling

Patients may reschedule an appointment without penalty provided they do so at least **24** hours in advance. You may move your appointment to any open slot within the provider's schedule.

Chronic Rescheduling Limit

To prevent schedule blocking, a single appointment can only be rescheduled a maximum of **three** consecutive times. If a patient attempts to reschedule a fourth time, the

appointment will be canceled, and the patient must initiate a completely new booking request.

Provider-Initiated Rescheduling

Medical emergencies occasionally require our doctors to leave the clinic unexpectedly (e.g., Dr. Jenkins being called to Neonatology or Dr. Thorne performing emergency joint surgery).

* If the clinic must cancel your appointment, you will be notified immediately via phone and text.

* You will be placed on a ****Priority Rescheduling List****.

* The scheduling team will offer you the next available slot, often overriding standard wait times, at no cost or penalty to you.

Waitlist Procedures

If your desired doctor is fully booked, you may request to be added to their cancellation waitlist. If a slot opens up, the automated system sends a text message to all waitlisted patients simultaneously. These slots are claimed on a strict first-come, first-served basis.